

Chen (Cassie) Zhang

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Education

Ph.D. in Econometrics and Quantitative Economics, University of California, Irvine (GPA: 3.91/4.00) Expected June 2027

M.A. in Econometrics and Quantitative Economics, University of California, Irvine (GPA: 3.81/4.00) December 2023

M.A. in International Comparative Education, Stanford University (GPA: 3.90/4.00) September 2020

Ignite Program, Graduate School of Business, Stanford University March 2020

B.A. in Economics and B.A. in International Studies (Double Major), UC Irvine (GPA: 3.83/4.00) March 2017
Magna Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa

Research Fields

Empirical Industrial Organization, Transportation Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Causal Inference, Energy Economics

Publications

Zhang, C. (2026). “Competition and Consumer Welfare in Airline Markets: Evidence from the Alaska–Hawaiian Merger.” *Journal of Air Transport Management*, 137, 103086. [\[Link\]](#)

Chen Zhang (2026). “Determinants of Electric Vehicle Purchasing Decisions: Implications for Government Policies.” *Energy Sources, Part B: Economics, Planning, and Policy*, 21. [\[Link\]](#)

Working Papers

“Beyond Fares: Multimarket Contact and Capacity Discipline in Airline Markets” (Job Market Paper)

“AI and the Labor Bubble: A General Equilibrium Theory of the Rise and Fall of Mass Employment” (with Jiawei Chen)

“Merging to Challenge the Market Leader: An Empirical Analysis in the Sports Drink Industry”

Work in Progress

“Behavioral and Fiscal Impacts of Vehicle Weight Fees in California” (with David Brownstone, David Bunch and Jiawei Chen)

Conference Presentations

53rd European Association for Research in Industrial Economics (EARIE) Conference, *Presenter* Aug 2026

42nd European Economics Association (EEA) Annual Conference, *Presenter* Aug 2026

The 29th Air Transport Research Society (ATRS) World Conference, *Presenter* Jul 2026

2026 Chinese Economists Society (CES) Annual Conference, *Session Chair, Presenter* Jul 2026

Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL, *Presenter* Nov 2025

Western Economic Association International 100th Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA, *Presenter* Jun 2025

Asia-Pacific Industrial Organization Conference (APIOC), Seoul, Korea, *Co-Presenter* Dec 2024

Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, *Presenter* Nov 2024

International Conference on Empirical Economics, Penn State, *Presenter, Session Chair* Aug 2024

2024 CES China Annual Conference, Zhejiang University, *Presenter, Session Chair* Jul 2024

Conference of Comparative and International Education Society, Miami, FL, *Presenter, Chair* Mar 2020

Teaching Experience

CSU Pre-Professor Program (PREPP), UC Irvine 2026–Present
Liaison School: California State University, East Bay

Summer Instructor, UC Irvine 2025; 2026
Probability Theory, Statistical Inference, and Econometrics (Undergraduate course)

California Community College Internship Program (CCCIP), Santa Ana College Jun 2025–Jun 2026
Microeconomic Theory

AI Writing & Digital Literacy Fellows Program 2025–Present
Faculty Learning Community of instructors from UC Irvine, Cal State Fullerton, and the North Orange County Community College District

Graduate Scholar, Division of Teaching Excellence & Innovation (DTEI), UC Irvine 2025; 2026

Graduate Instructor, UC Irvine Jan–Apr 2024
Instrumental Variables and Nonparametric Regression (PhD level)

Teaching Assistant, UC Irvine Sep 2022–Sep 2024
 Applied Econometrics II; Intermediate Quantitative Econometrics I; Graduate Micro Econometrics
 and Public Policy; Probability and Statistics II; Corporate Finance; Behavioral Economics

Professional Experience

Graduate Student Researcher, UC Irvine Sep 2024–Present

- Secured \$450k in competitive research funding by co-authoring grant proposals for the California Transportation Commission and the Pacific Southwest Region (PSR) University Transportation Center.
- Lead researcher on multi-agency transportation initiatives; developed nested logit, BLP, and simulation models for EV adoption and vehicle weight-fee policy analysis.

Transit Researcher Intern, California Air Resources Board Mar–Jun 2025

- Designed quantitative GHG evaluation frameworks for \$10B+ in TIRCP-funded transit projects.
- Developed statistical prediction methods for emissions reduction and ridership at the funding stage.

Program Director, Education Without Barriers Aug 2020–Sep 2021

- Designed curricula for 1,000+ children in rural China and Kenya; conducted quasi-experimental impact evaluation.

Operations Intern, Hospitality Systems Consultants Inc. (Stanford SEED) Jun–Aug 2020

Awards and Fellowships

2026 ATRS Best Student Paper Award, Shortlisted — “Beyond Fares: Multimarket Contact and Capacity Discipline in Airline Markets”	2026
Otto W. Shaler Scholarship (\$11,500)	2025
Ken Small Award	2025
DECADE Professional Development Awards	2025
UC Irvine Summer Research Fellowship	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Long US-China Institute Graduate Student Research Fellowship	2024
European Association for Research in Industrial Economics (EARIE) Summer School	2024
NABE Full Scholarship for Economic Measurement Seminar	2023
UC Irvine Social Sciences Merit Fellowship	2021
UREAG Travel Grant Recipient	2020

Skills

Programming: Python, MATLAB, R, Stata, SQLite, JMP

Tools: PyBLP, dask, numpy, matplotlib, NVivo, L^AT_EX

Methods: Structural Estimation (BLP), Causal Inference (DID, Synthetic Control, IV), Discrete Choice Models, Counterfactual Simulation

Certifications

Foundation for Data Science (Stanford) · Business Analytics Specialization (UPenn, Coursera) · Economic Measurement (NABE)

Professional Service

Session Chair: CES Annual Conference (2024, 2026), International Conference on Empirical Economics (2024), CIES (2020)